Find your *sixth gear.*

A four-step worksheet for finding the work AI should take off your team's plate, checking you're ready, making the business case, and planning a pilot you can measure. Fill it in on your own, or bring it to your free workshop with us.

01 Identify bottlenecks and map the workflow

02 Assess readiness and risks

03 Build a case estimating costs and outcomes

04 Plan the pilot

01

Identify bottlenecks and map the workflow

List the work that's repetitive, rules-based and eating your team's week. Score how much each one hurts.

Your candidate workflows

WORKFLOW	WHO DOES IT	HOURS / WEEK	PAIN (1–5)	TOOLS AND DATA USED
e.g. Matching supplier invoices to POs	*Finance, 2 people*	*14*	*4*	*Email, Xero, spreadsheet*

Map your top workflow, step by step

Where does the work start, what decisions get made, where does it wait, and where does it end?

#	STEP	MANUAL OR AUTOMATIC?	WHERE IT WAITS OR BREAKS
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Good first candidates are high-volume, follow clear rules, use data you already have, and have a person who reviews the result today.

02

Assess readiness and risks

Be honest here. Gaps aren't blockers; they tell you what to fix first.

Readiness check for your top workflow

QUESTION	READY	PARTLY	NOT YET
Can we access the data this workflow uses (systems, inboxes, files)?	☐	☐	☐
Do our tools have APIs or exports we can connect to?	☐	☐	☐
Are the rules written down, or could someone explain them in an hour?	☐	☐	☐
Is there one person who owns this workflow and its results?	☐	☐	☐
Do we know how we measure it today (time, volume, errors)?	☐	☐	☐
Will a person review outputs before they reach customers or the books?	☐	☐	☐
Have we checked privacy, security and compliance requirements?	☐	☐	☐

Risks and how we'll handle them

RISK	LIKELIHOOD (L/M/H)	IMPACT (L/M/H)	MITIGATION
e.g. Agent miscodes an invoice	*M*	*M*	*Human approves before posting*

03

Build a case estimating costs and outcomes

A rough, defensible number beats a precise guess. Use conservative estimates.

Time saved

HOURS / WEEK TODAY × % AUTOMATED × LOADED COST / HOUR × WEEKS / YEAR (≈48)

= ANNUAL VALUE OF TIME SAVED

Other outcomes

Faster turnaround (before → after):

Fewer errors or rework:

More volume without hiring:

Customer or team experience:

Costs

Build and setup (one-off):

Running costs (AI, hosting) / month:

Team time to review and adopt:

Payback period (months):

Tip: pick one KPI the business already tracks, such as hours per week, cost per transaction or response time, and make it the headline of your case.

04

Plan the pilot

Small scope, clear owner, measured from day one. Prove it on one workflow, then scale.

Scope

Workflow and what's in or out:

Owner and reviewers

Who owns it, who checks outputs:

Success KPIs

KPI	BASELINE TODAY	PILOT TARGET	HOW WE MEASURE IT

Timeline

WEEK 1
Access, data samples, rules written down.

WEEK 2
Build the first version and test on past cases.

WEEK 3
Run live with human review on every output.

WEEK 4
Measure against KPIs and decide go or no-go.

Go / no-go criteria

Want help filling this in?
Book a free workshop with our founder.

Book a call →